



WELCOME



Lecture: 03

Ancient Bengal- Pre Aryan, Aryan, Dynasties

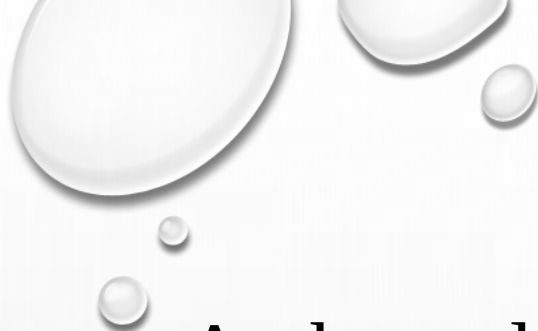
Course Title: History of the Emergence of Bangladesh
Course Code: BDS 1201

Presented by: Nabila Sultana
Adjunct Faculty
United International University (UIU)



Contents

- Pre-Aryan
- Aryan
- Maurya Dynasty
- Gupta Dynasty
- Post-Gupta Dynasty
- Sena Dynasty



Anthropologists agree that Bangladesh has historically been a land of many races.

Long before the arrival of the Aryans in the 5th and 6th centuries B.C., The Bangalees were already racially mixed.



- It is said that the origin of human beings is in Africa, but that some of them at first moved into the northern part of the middle east and then dispersed across the world. The groups of the people who went to south-east Asia had crossed the land of Bangladesh several thousand years ago. These people developed languages, known as Austric languages with their name Austric or Austro-Asiatic people.
- Near about the same time or later some other people, whom we now classify as mongoloid also entered the territories of Bangladesh from the east and spread mainly into the uplands and hilly areas.



Similarly many races of the various part of the world came in Bengal from time to time. The main reasons for coming to Bengal were:

- First, the zeal to conquer and occupy a new region
 - Second, to do business in the wealthy and prosperous Bengal
 - Third, suitable environment of Bengal to live in.
 - Fourth, to preach the message of Islam
- 

Pre-Aryan Nation

- Negrito
- Australoid
- Dravidian
- Alpenoid

Aryan Nation

According to the Anthropologist

1. Austro-Asiatic from South East Asia
2. Mongoloid from East part of Asia
3. Dravidian from the Southern and western parts of South-Asia
4. Indo-Aryan people from the Northern part of the Middle-East and the Eastern part of Europe.

Origin and Identity of the People of Bangladesh

Indigenous People: Jele,
Dome, Bede, Chondal

Non Aryan People: Austric,
Dravidian, Mongoloid

Aryan People: From Middle
East and East Europe

Others People: Pala, Sena,
Arabs, Turks, Persian, Shak,
Mughal, Pathan etc.

Maurya Dynasty (321- 185 B.C.)

- Founder- Chandragupta Maurya
- Capital- Pataliputra later Pundranagar
- Mauryan rule was established in North Bengal during the reign of Emperor Asoka (269- 232 B.C.).
- Mahasthangarh in Bogra bears the memory
- Included Karnasuborna (Murshidabad), Tamralipti (Hooghly) and Samatata (South-East Bengal)
- Largest empire to rule the Indian subcontinent
- Ended in 185 B.C. with the rise of the Sunga Dynasty in Magadha

**Famous Emperor in
Maurya Dynasty**

Chandragupta

Bindusara

Ashoka

Gupta Dynasty (320- 550 A.D.)

- Magadha (now Bihar) state in North-Eastern India...
- Maharaja Sri Gupta (240-280 A.D.) & Chandragupta I (320-335 A.D.)
- Whole of Bengal under the Gupta rule except Samatata
- Capital- Pundranagar
- Hinduism
- Golden Age in the arts, sciences and religion
- lasted till the middle of the sixth century

**Emperor in
Gupta Dynasty**

**Maharaja Sri
Gupta**

Chandragupta I

Samudragupta

Bengal in Post Gupta Period

- attacks of a aggressive mountainous tribe, the Huns
- many small kingdoms rose throughout the whole of North India
- political unrest that affected North India
- Banga & Gaur
- Sasanka powerful king of Gaur (Mahasena Gupta)
- The ruler of any big region under the Gupta kings was called “Mahasamanta”.

- extended his kingdom by conquering the kingdom of Dandabhukti, Utkal of Orissa, kingdom of Kanghod and Magadha of Bihar. The kings of Kamrupa were also defeated by him.
- Sasanka then thought of conquering north india. This region was divided into two powerful kingdoms – (i) Thaneshwar (ii) Kanyakubza (kanauj).
- Sasanka died a little before 637 A.D.

Matsyanayam

When the strong and big fishes catch and eat up the smaller ones it is called “matsyanayam”. The powerful lords of Bengal began to swallow the small regions in the same manner. This unrest in Bengal continued for one hundred years. With the rise of the pala dynasty in the middle of eighth century this unrest came to an end.

The Pala Dynasty (750- 1160 A.D.)

- **Gopala (756-781 A.D.)**- founder of the Pala Dynasty (Gaur)
- Pala dynasty ruled Bengal for four hundred years
- Capital-Vikrampur (Munshiganj), later to Pataliputra, and then to Gaur
- Gopala's region- North-East Bengal

- **Dharmapala (781-821 A.D.)**- Son of Gopala, great pala king
- ruled in Bengal and Bihar
- Capital-Somapura (Naogaon)
- “Tripartite War”, the battle with King Nagbhatta II of Gurjara-Pratihara
- Dharmapala conquered Varanasi and Prayaga and extended his kingdom up to the region situated between the middle part of the Ganges and the Jamuna. Some historians say that he also conquered Nepal and reigned for about 40 years.

- **Devapala (821-861 A.D.)**- son of Dharmapala
- Capital- Monghyr (Munger)
- two reputed Brahmin ministers- Darvapani and Kedaramisra
- attacks on the Pratihara and Rashtrakuta kings
- Most widespread during Devapala's time.

Weak and inactive Rulers

- Reign of Vigrahapala I to Vigrahapala II (861-989 A.D.)
- Narayanpala (866-920 A.D.)
- Rajyapala (920-952 A.D.) and Gopala II (952-969 A.D.)
- started to break down

- Mahipala I (995-1043 A.D.)- liberated North and West Bengal
- Capital- Murshidabad
- with his death the empire broke down immediately.
- After him, his son Nayapala (1043-1058 A.D.) and his grandson Vighrahapala III (1058-1075 A.D.) came. They could not protect the empire from foreign attacks. Bihar, outside Bengal began to slip away. During the reign of Vighrahapala III, the Pala Empire in Bengal broke into many pieces.

- Mahipala II (1075-1080 A.D.) – lost Barendra region
- Surapala II (younger brother of Mahipala II)
- Rampala (1082-1124 A.D.)- last successful ruler of Pala Dynasty, recovered Barendra,
- new capital called Ramavati near the present Maldah.

- after Rampala, Kumara pala (1124-1129 A.D.), Gopala iii (1129-1143 a.D.) And Madana pala (1143-1161 A.D.) came
- after Madana Pala named Govindapala came
- daily warfare
- collapse of the Pala Dynasty

Some Pala Rulers

- ☐ Dharmapala
- ☐ Devapala
- ☐ Gopala I
- ☐ Mahipala
- ☐ Narayanpala
- ☐ Rajyapala
- ☐ Bindusara
- ☐ Gopala II
- ☐ Dhana Nanda
- ☐ Ramapala
- ☐ Mahipala II

The independent kingdom of south-east bengal

The south-east bengal was independent most of the time during the time of the palas. This region was in the “banga” janapada of the ancient time. From the middle of the eighth century A.D. Many dynasties ruled in this region.

- The Kharga Dynasty
- The Deva Dynasty
- The Kingdom of Kanti Deva
- The Chandra Dynasty
- The Varmanaraja Dynasty

Sena Dynasty (1070-1230 A.D.)

- Hindu dynasty
- Covered much of the north-eastern region of the Indian subcontinent.
- At first they were Brahmins. Later when they became skilled in warfare, they earned the title “Khatrya”.
- founder of Sena Dynasty was Samanta Sena (settled in the Rahr region)
- his son Hemanta Sena- feudal king under the Pala Emperor Rampala

- **Vijay Sena (1098-1160 A.D.)**- conquered North-West Bengal, Kamrupa, Kalinga and Mithila.
- **Vallala Sena (1160-1178 A.D.)**- conquered Gaur from the Pala
- **Lakhshmana Sena (1178-1206 A.D.)**- ruled Bengal and expanded the Sena Empire to Assam, Orisha, Bihar. Coming to the end of his reign Lakhshmana Sena became quite weak. As a result, the feudal lords around him started to revolt.

- In the beginning of the thirteenth century, the Muslim power from the north began to proceed towards Bengal. The Muslim commander Ikhtiaruddin Muhammad Bakhtiar Khalji attacked Nadia, the second capital of Sena dynasty. Being defeated Lakhshmana Sena fled to east Bengal. North and north-west Bengal went under the Muslim rule. Lakhshmana Sena ruled for more two years and died in 1206 A.D. Though the Sena rule continued for some time more, it can be very well be said that with the defeat of Lakhshmana Sena the Sena rule in Bengal came to an end.

THANK
YOU!
